

Hackathon (Innovation Sprint)

Teams design, build, and pitch a functional software/hardware prototype that solves a real-world problem statement released at the opening ceremony, within a fixed development window.

Rules & Specifications

Team Composition	Minimum 3, maximum 5 members per team. All members must be currently enrolled university/college students.
Duration & Format	24-hour continuous, on-site hackathon. Problem statements/tracks are revealed at the opening ceremony; no prior development on the submitted idea is allowed.
Tech Stack	Any programming language, framework, or hardware platform may be used. Use of open-source libraries and public APIs is permitted, provided it is disclosed at submission.
Originality Rule	All code and design work must be produced during the event window. Pre-built projects, templates, or previously published code (beyond disclosed libraries) are not allowed and will be disqualified as plagiarism.
Submission Requirements	- A public GitHub/GitLab repository link with complete source code. - A working live demo or recorded walkthrough. - A maximum 5-minute pitch presentation to the judging panel.
Judging Criteria	- Innovation & Originality — 25% - Technical Execution & Functionality — 25% - Real-World Impact & Feasibility — 25% - Presentation & Pitch Clarity — 25%
Conduct & Penalties	- Attacking event Wi-Fi/infrastructure or rival teams' devices leads to immediate disqualification and possible legal action. - Teams must stop coding once time expires; only minor bug fixes are allowed during judging.

Registration & Prize

REGISTRATION FEE Early Bird: Rs. 2,500 Regular: Rs. 3,000	PRIZE POOL Up to Rs. 40,000
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General Rules — Applicable to This Category

- Strict Punctuality — Teams must report to their arena, lab, stage, or table 15 minutes before their scheduled heat or session. Late arrival results in automatic forfeit.
- Fair Play & Sportsmanship — Abusive behavior, argument with referees/judges, or unsportsmanlike conduct leads to immediate disqualification.
- Original Work — All code, models, designs, and submissions must be the team's own original work produced within the stated contest window. Plagiarism or use of undisclosed pre-existing material leads to disqualification.
- Network & Infrastructure Integrity — Attacking, disrupting, or attempting unauthorized access to event Wi-Fi, judging platforms, gaming servers, or another team's systems/devices is strictly prohibited and may result in disqualification and legal action.
- Judge's Decision — The decision of the technical panel, head referees, and judges is indisputable and final.

These rules are issued by the Capital Youth Expo organizing committee and apply alongside the master rulebook. The committee reserves the right to modify rules, time limits, or format if necessary. Judges' decisions are final and non-contestable.